

THE UNREST BJP supporters protest in Jaipur to demand a ticket for Bansur leader Mahendra Yadav, Oct. 13

ASSEMBLY POLLS 2023

RAJASTHAN

DISSENT IN THE RANKS

THE BJP HAS FOCUSED ON ITS WEAKEST SEATS IN THE FIRST LIST, BUT EVEN HERE THERE IS A BACKLASH AGAINST HALF OF THE CANDIDATES, SOME OF THEM MPs

By Rohit Parihar

Vasundhara Raje was all over the news in mid-October. On October 15, the BJP leader and former chief minister had what the media called a 'secret meeting' with former rival and current Assam governor Gulab Chand Kataria at his Udaipur residence. Later, she even shared a ride with BJP president J.P. Nadda, who was also visiting the city. The official version is that the meetings were to discuss the party's inability to create a pre-poll wave in its favour, like it had in 2003 and 2013. The Kataria meeting, though, had evoked so much interest because very few from the Raje camp found a place in the party's first list of 41 candidates for the assembly election on November 23. The disaffection seems to be widespread, for there were unexpected revolts in 20 places.